

WEIRD WORLD

ALTHOUGH ANIMAL HUNTS CONTINUED IN AMPHITHEATERS UNTIL THE 6TH CENTURY CE, IT BECAME EXPENSIVE TO OBTAIN AND FEED WILD BEASTS. FIGHTERS HAD TO KILL BULLS INSTEAD.

Beginning of the end

By the late 4th century CE, barbarian tribes, such as the Visigoths and Vandals, were moving into Roman territory. Legions were recalled from the farthest outposts of the empire to defend Rome, but they couldn't stop the Visigoths from destroying much of the city in 410 CE. The empire was falling apart.

A New Rome

In 476 CE, the last Western emperor, Romulus Augustulus, was overthrown by a Germanic chieftain, Odoacer, who made himself king of Italy. The 16-year-old Romulus entered the history books as the last true emperor of Rome.

Roman ways carried on for several hundred years in the eastern part of the empire, where a "New Rome" had been built, named Constantinople (now Istanbul, in modern-day Turkey). But one thing had gone forever—gladiators.

ALARIC, KING OF THE VISIGOTHS, ENTERS ROME WITH HIS WARRIORS IN 410 CE.

